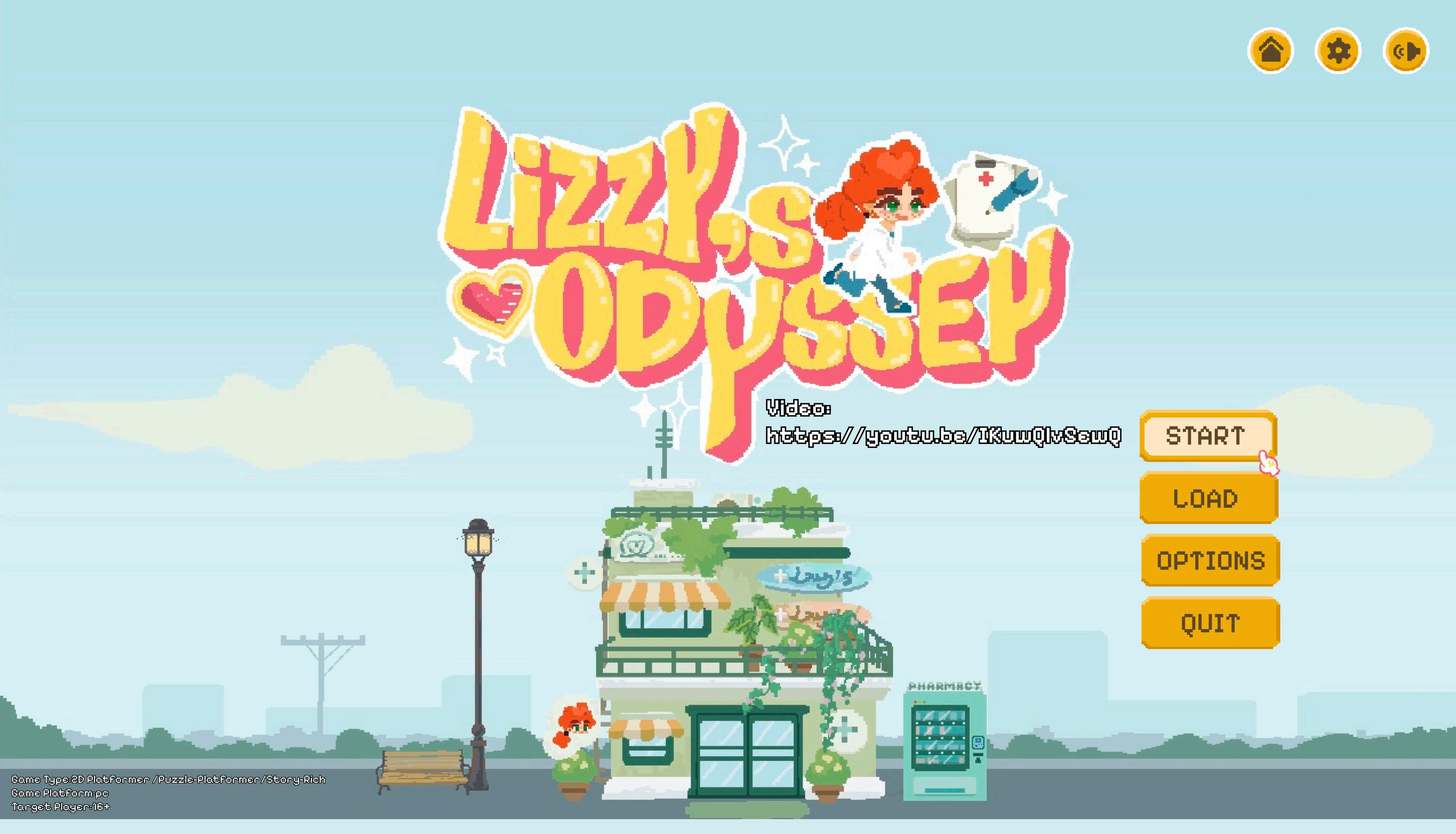


Video:
https://youtu.be/IKuwQlvSewQ

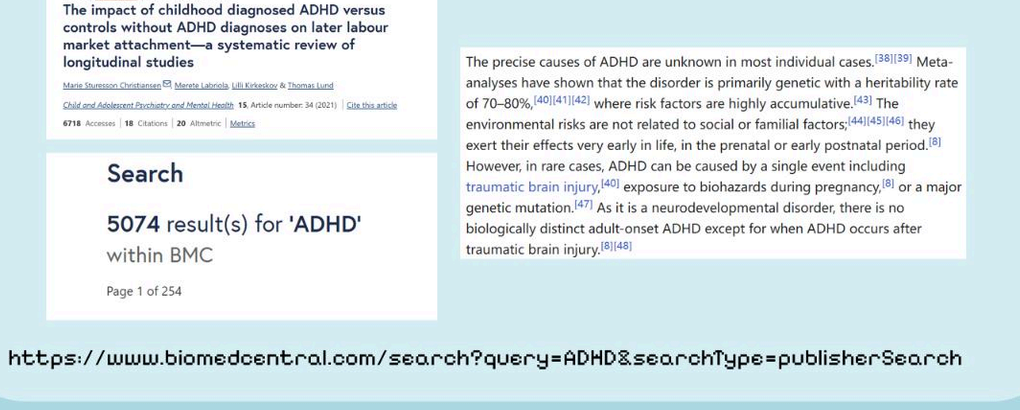
Game Type:2D Platformer /Puzzle-Platformer/Story-Rich
Game Platform:pc
Target Player:16+

Research

《Lizzy's Odyssey》: A Healing Journey Grounded in Psychological Science.

ADHD & Executive Function Training (Mushroom Jungle):

According to a study in JAMA Psychiatry, approximately 5.9% of children and adolescents globally are diagnosed with ADHD. A core difficulty lies in impaired executive functions. The game's "collecting puzzle pieces" mechanic is a direct metaphor for Executive Function Training. This non-pharmacological intervention uses structured tasks (like puzzles) to specifically improve working memory, cognitive flexibility, and planning, thereby helping individuals integrate scattered cognitive resources.



The impact of childhood diagnosed ADHD versus controls without ADHD diagnoses on later labour market attachment—a systematic review of longitudinal studies

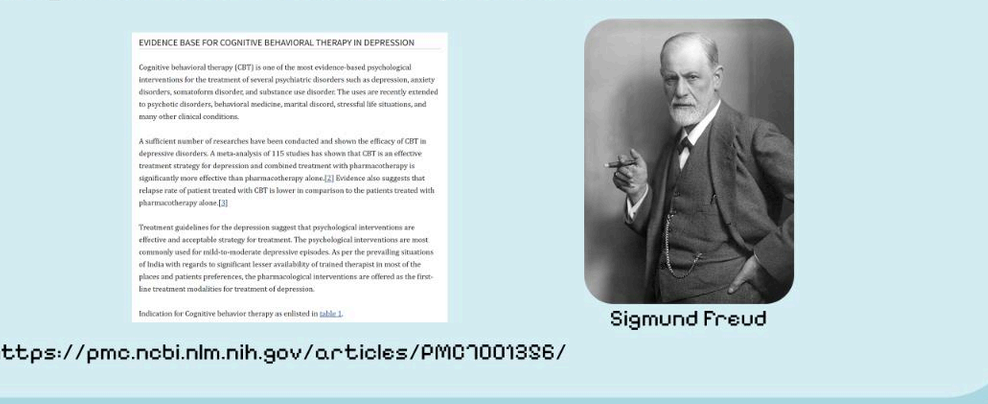
Search
5074 result(s) for 'ADHD'
within BMC
Page 1 of 254

The precise causes of ADHD are unknown in most individual cases.[38][39] Meta-analyses have shown that the disorder is primarily genetic with a heritability rate of 70–80%,[40][41][42] where risk factors are highly accumulative.[43] The environmental risks are not related to social or familial factors;[44][45][46] they exert their effects very early in life, in the prenatal or early postnatal period.[8] However, in rare cases, ADHD can be caused by a single event including traumatic brain injury,[40] exposure to biohazards during pregnancy,[8] or a major genetic mutation.[47] As it is a neurodevelopmental disorder, there is no biologically distinct adult-onset ADHD except for when ADHD occurs after traumatic brain injury.[8][48]

https://www.biomedcentral.com/search?query=ADHD&searchType=publisherSearch

Depression & Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT) (Seabed Search for the Id):

The World Health Organization reports that depression affects about 3.8% of the global population. The pursuing "Superego" in the game draws from Freudian theory and is recognized in modern psychology as the "inner critic." Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT), a first-line treatment for depression, aims to help patients identify and challenge these automatic negative thoughts. The gameplay of evading the "Superego" (challenging negative thoughts) to find the "Id" (reconnecting with inner values and pleasure) vividly recreates the core process of CBT.



EVIDENCE BASE FOR COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY IN DEPRESSION

Sigmund Freud

https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC7001356/

Alzheimer's & Reminiscence Therapy (Snowy Fog Scenario):

Alzheimer's Disease International reports over 55 million people living with dementia worldwide. The disease devastates the brain's episodic memory system. The design of "unlocking memory houses" directly corresponds to an effective non-pharmacological intervention-Reminiscence Therapy. This approach, which uses prompts like photos and music to guide structured recall of personal experiences, has been shown to effectively stimulate residual memory pathways, improve mood, reduce anxiety, and enhance self-identity.

Sensory therapies. There is some evidence that sensory therapies such as music therapy and art therapy can improve Alzheimer's patients' mood, behavior, and day-to-day function. By stimulating the senses, these therapies may help trigger memory recall and enable Alzheimer's patients to reconnect with the world around them.

感官疗法。有证据表明，音乐疗法和艺术疗法等感官疗法可以改善阿尔茨海默病患者的情绪、行为和日常功能。通过刺激感官，这些疗法可能有助于触发记忆回忆，并使阿尔茨海默病患者重新与周围世界建立联系。

World Alzheimer Report 2024

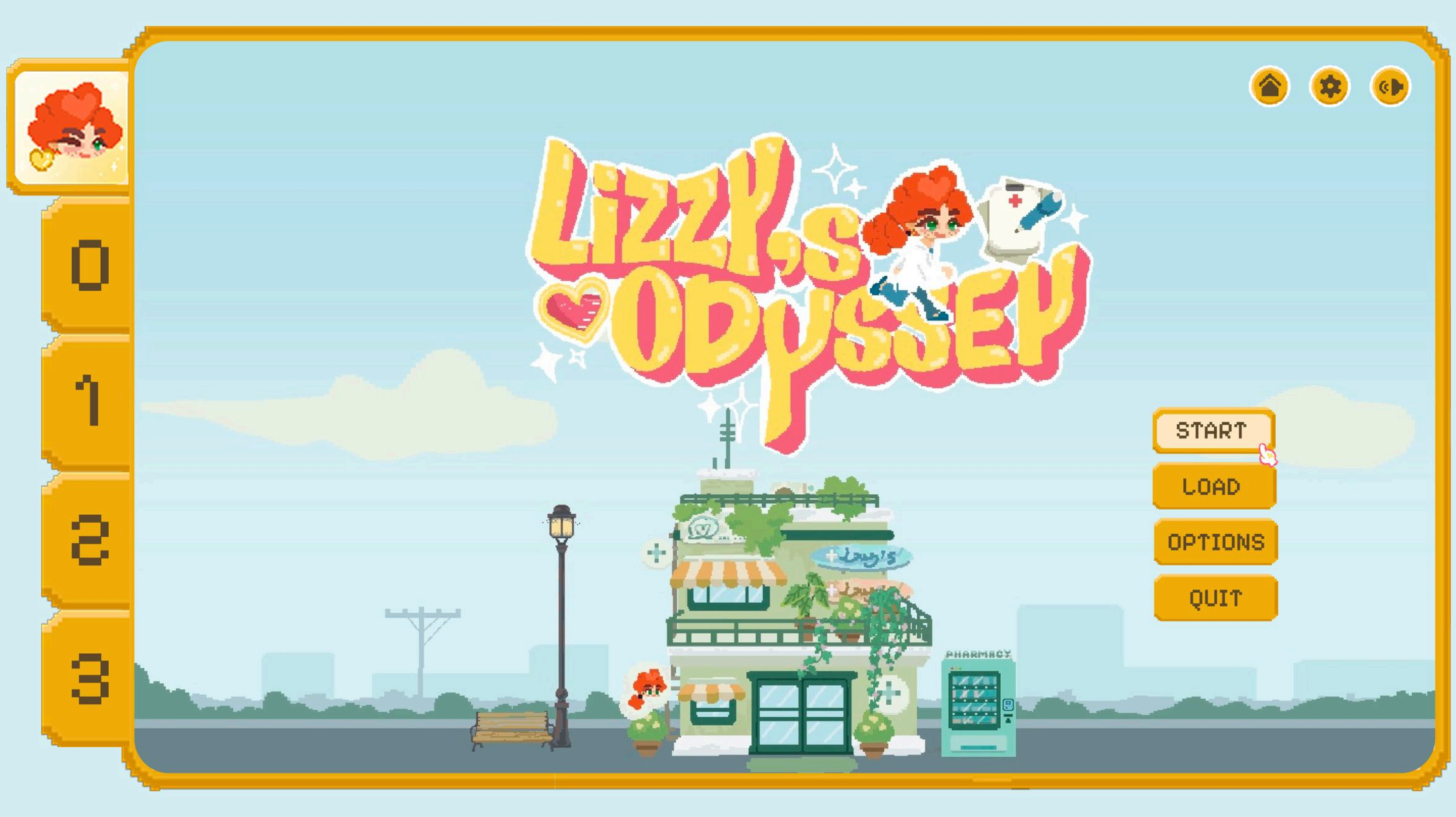
https://www.alzint.org/resource/world-alzheimer-report-2024/

The creation of Lizzy's Odyssey is deeply rooted in established psychological research, aiming to visualize abstract mental health challenges and their clinical interventions through interactive media, thereby enhancing public understanding and reducing stigma.

By translating rigorous scientific theory and clinical methods into a playable experience, Lizzy's Odyssey serves not just as a game, but as a bridge to greater understanding and empathy.

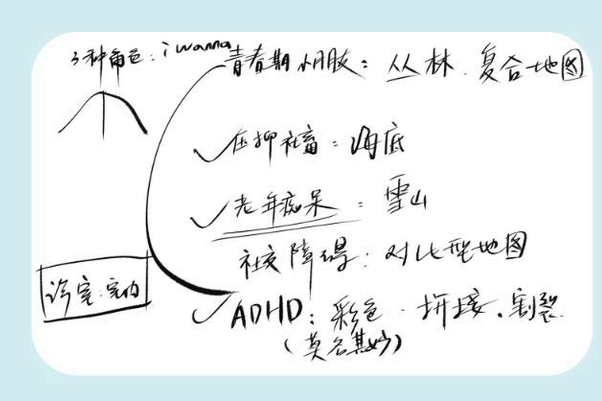
Introduction

Lizzy's Odyssey is a heartwarming 2D platformer that invites you to step beyond the therapist's couch and embark on an unprecedented journey-into the very minds of your patients.



Inspiration

The scattered attention of a child with ADHD, the deep-sea despair of depression, and the foggy memory loss of an elderly person with dementia. We transformed these complex concepts into engaging gameplay mechanics: collecting focus-scattered puzzle pieces in a whimsical "Mushroom Jungle"; evading the critical "Superego" to find the lost "Id" in the abyssal depths; and unlocking memory-filled houses shrouded in "Snowy Fog."



Background

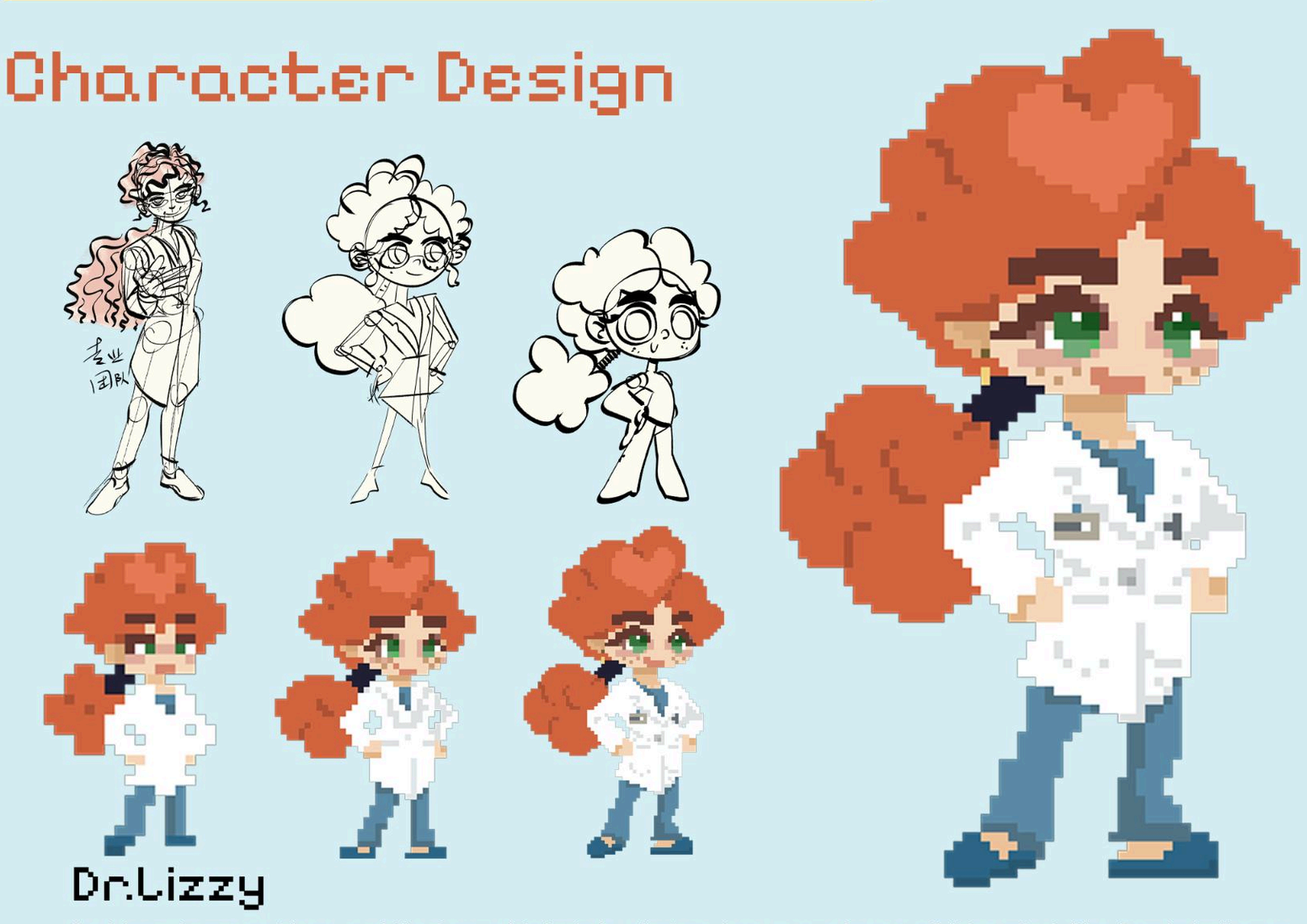
This game was born from a simple yet profound question: How can we truly "see" the inner struggles of others? As indie developers, we wanted to leverage the unique power of interactive media to make abstract mental health challenges tangible and relatable. Thus, we created Dr. Lizzy, whose "Odyssey" does not unfold in an external vast world, but inward, through the vibrant yet troubled landscapes of three unique minds.

Objective

This is more than a platforming challenge; it's an exercise in empathy. We hope players, by guiding Lizzy through these worlds, will not only enjoy the puzzles and action but also gain a deeper understanding of unspoken pains and witness the spark of healing and hope. Welcome to Lizzy's Odyssey-a wondrous adventure into the human psyche.

CONSULTING ROOM

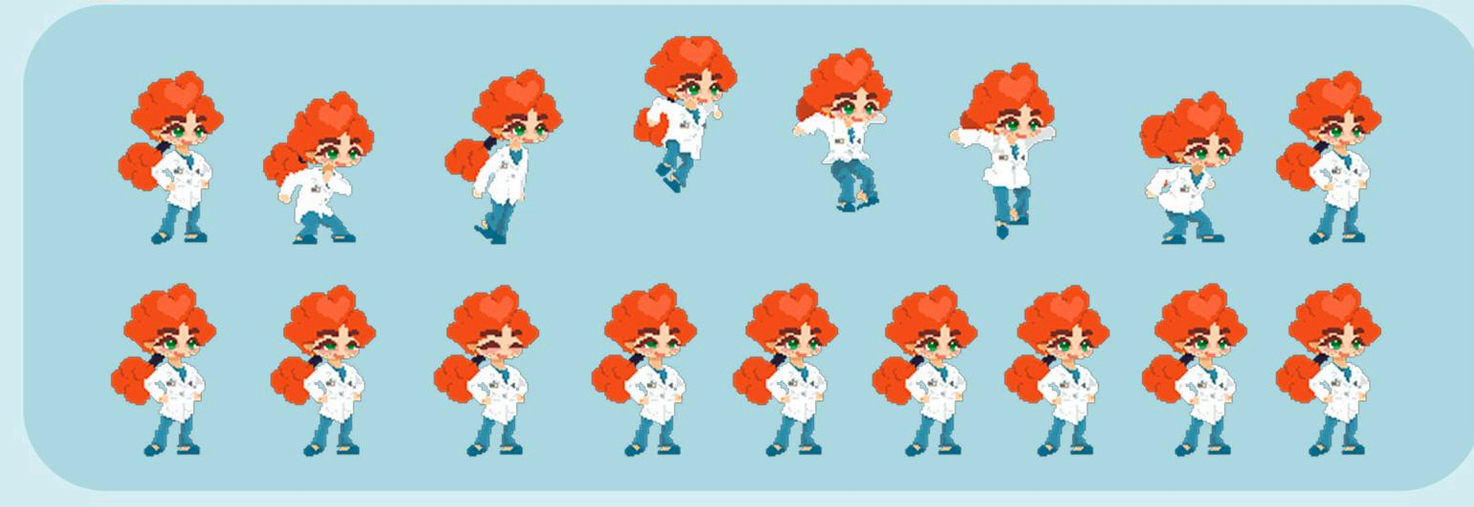
Character Design



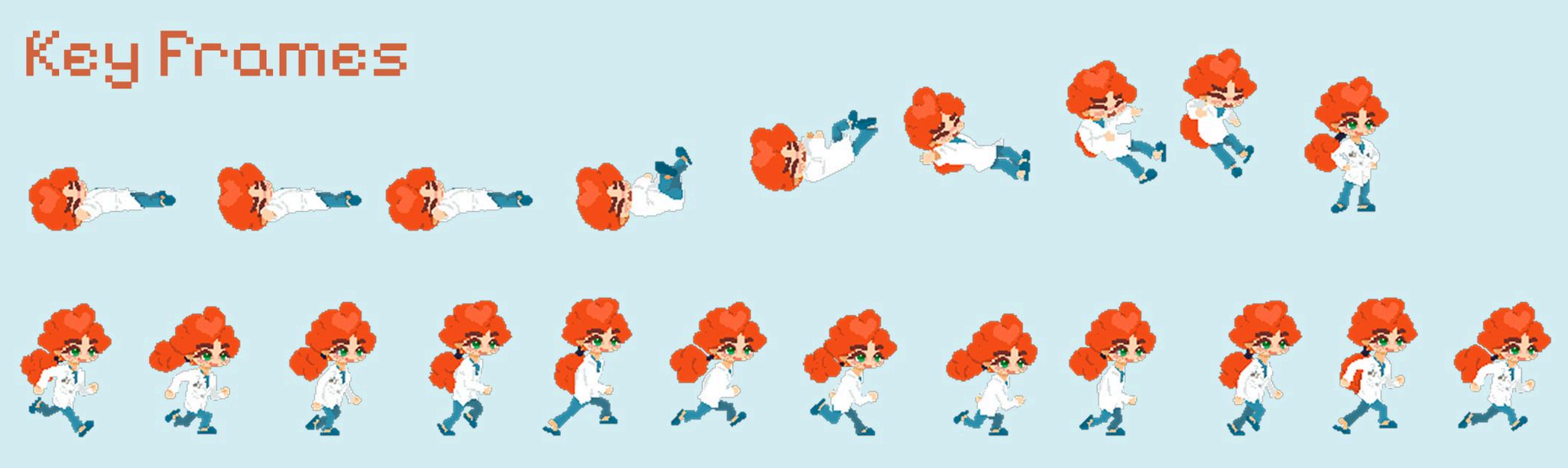
Dr.Lizzy

Dr. Lizzy is more than a skilled psychiatrist; she's a brave explorer of the mind. She firmly believes that true healing begins with understanding. Gifted with profound empathy, she has the unique ability to step into her patients' inner worlds, transforming abstract emotional struggles into tangible, fantastical landscapes.

Key Frames

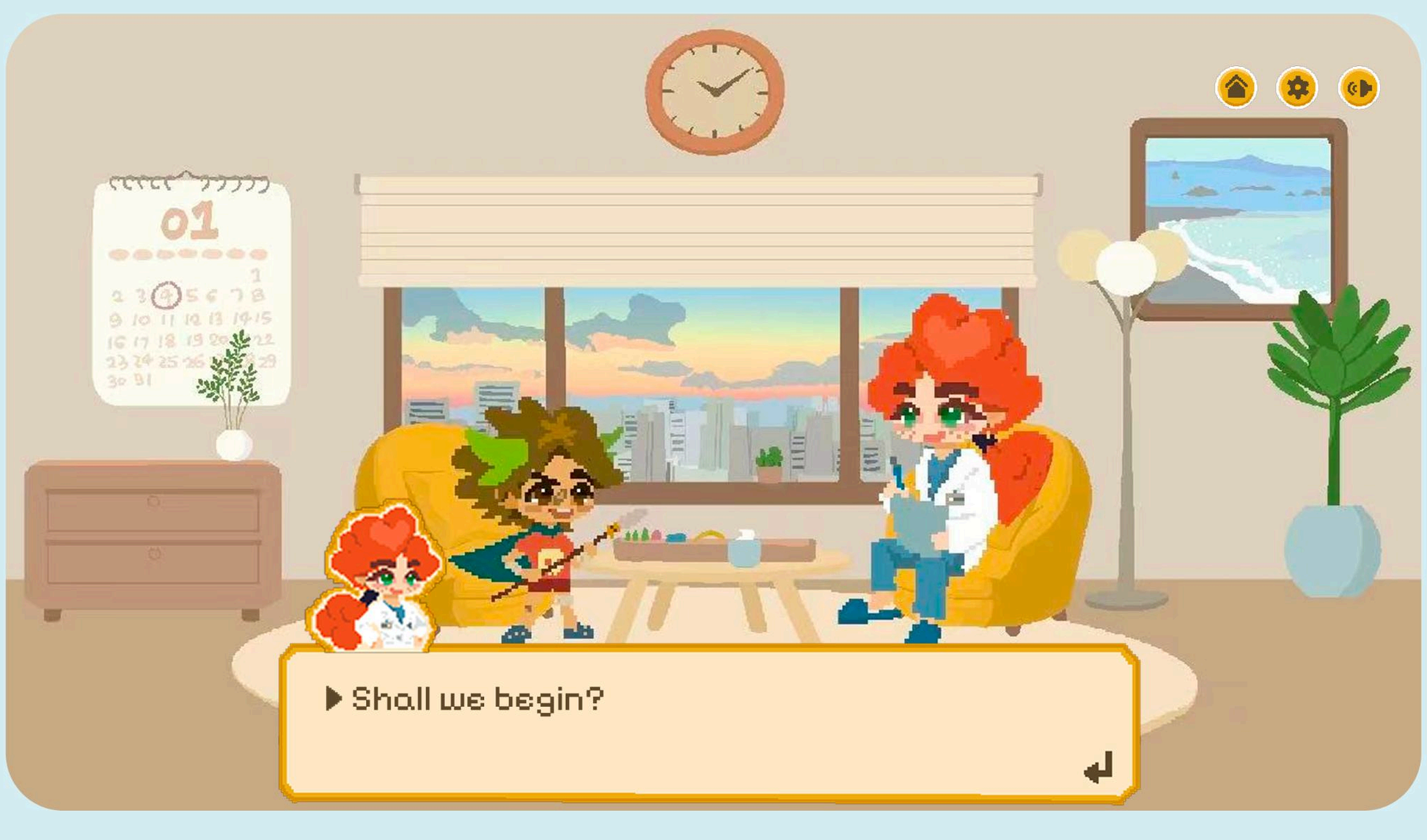


Key Frames

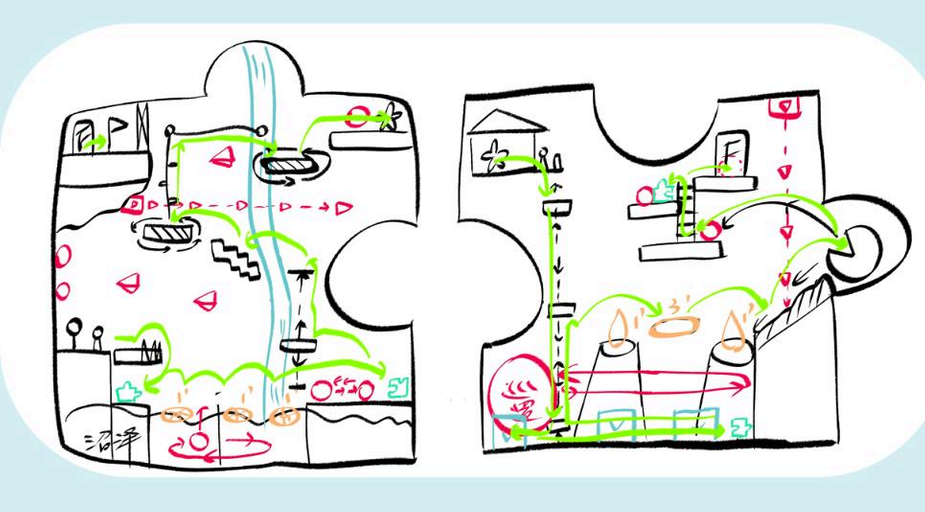


Layout Design

The consultation room uses bright colors (orange and milky white) and rounded corners. Doctors and patients do not sit together. The tables and chairs are relatively soft, and some paintings, sand figurines, and plants can be placed there.

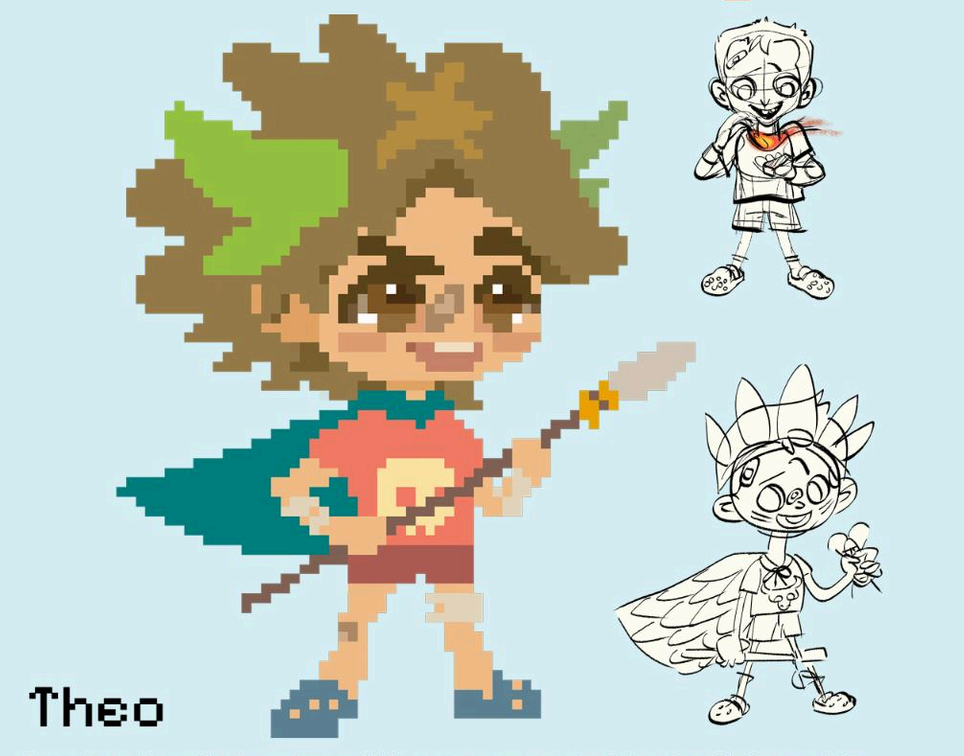


LEVEL-1



How to pass: Find all the puzzle pieces and complete the puzzle within the time limit.

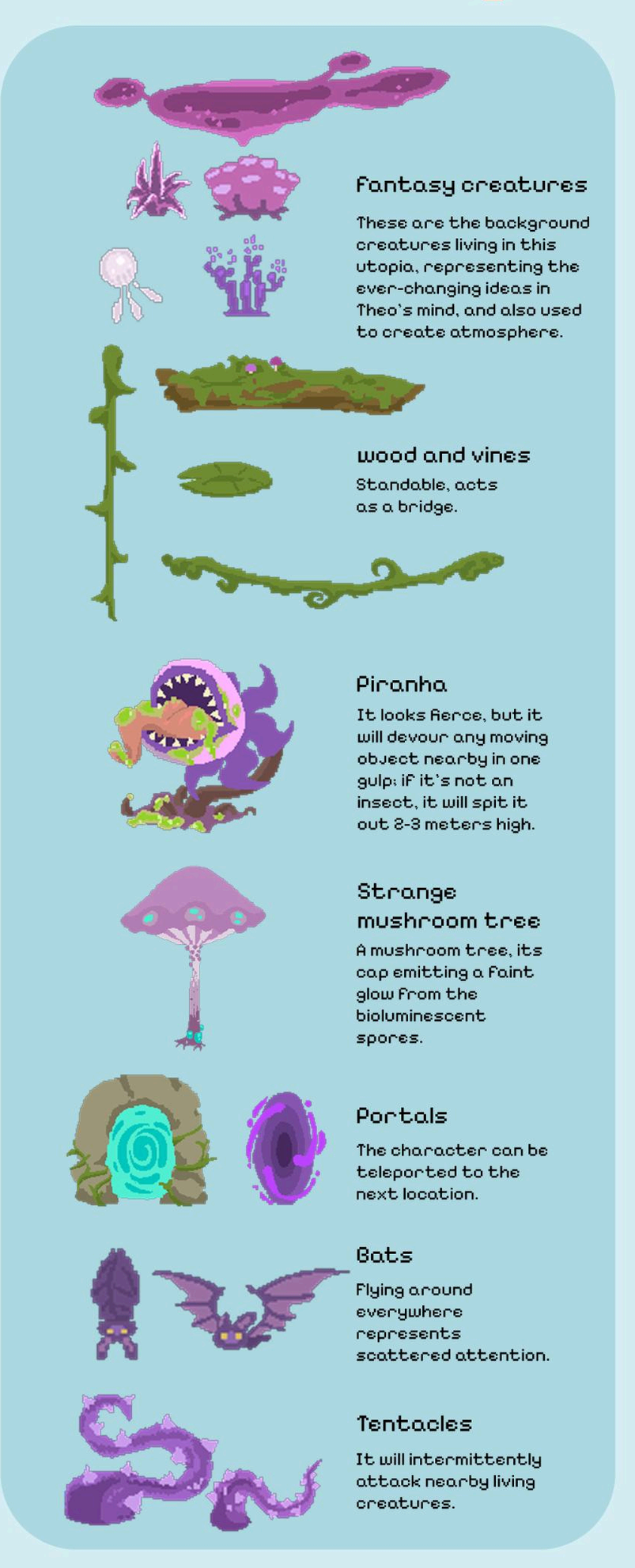
Character Design



Theo

heo is a boy brimming with energy and whimsical ideas. His inner world resembles a vibrant yet chaotic "Mushroom Jungle." His focus is like a tireless butterfly, flitting rapidly between countless thoughts, making it hard for him to concentrate on one thing. He isn't being disobedient; it's just that his brain's stage has too many exciting shows playing at once.

Element Design



Fantasy creatures
These are the background creatures living in this utopia, representing the ever-changing ideas in Theo's mind, and also used to create atmosphere.

wood and vines
Standable, acts as a bridge.

Piranha
It looks fierce, but it will devour any moving object nearby in one gulp; if it's not an insect, it will spit it out 2-3 meters high.

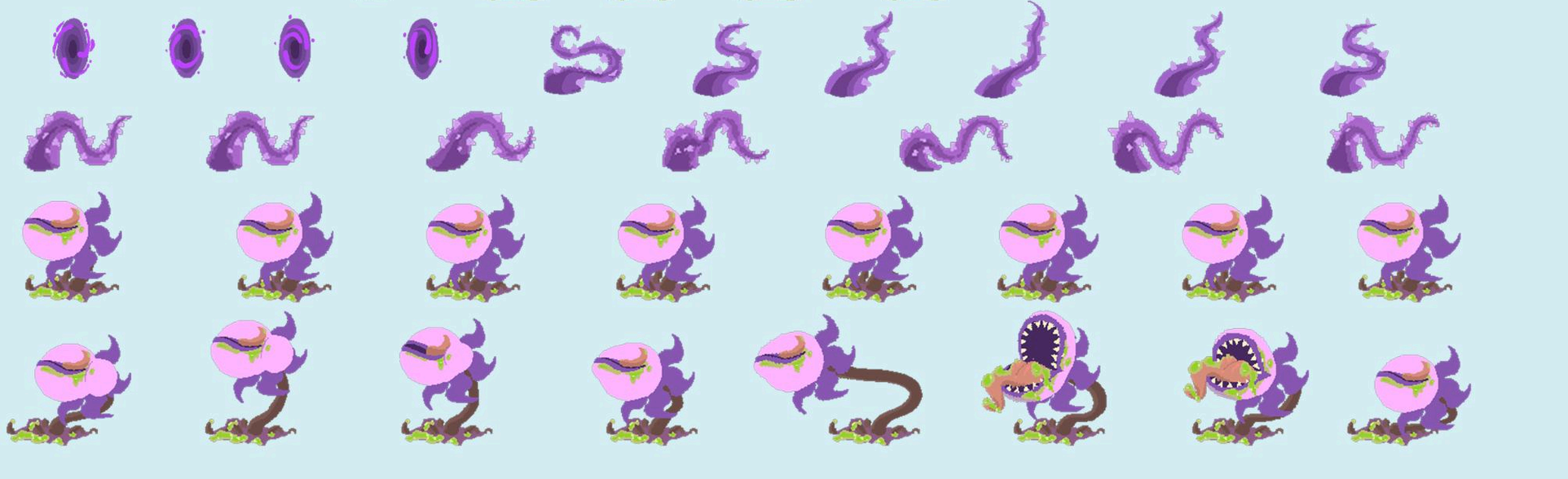
Strange mushroom tree
A mushroom tree, its cap emitting a faint glow from the bioluminescent spores.

Portals
The character can be teleported to the next location.

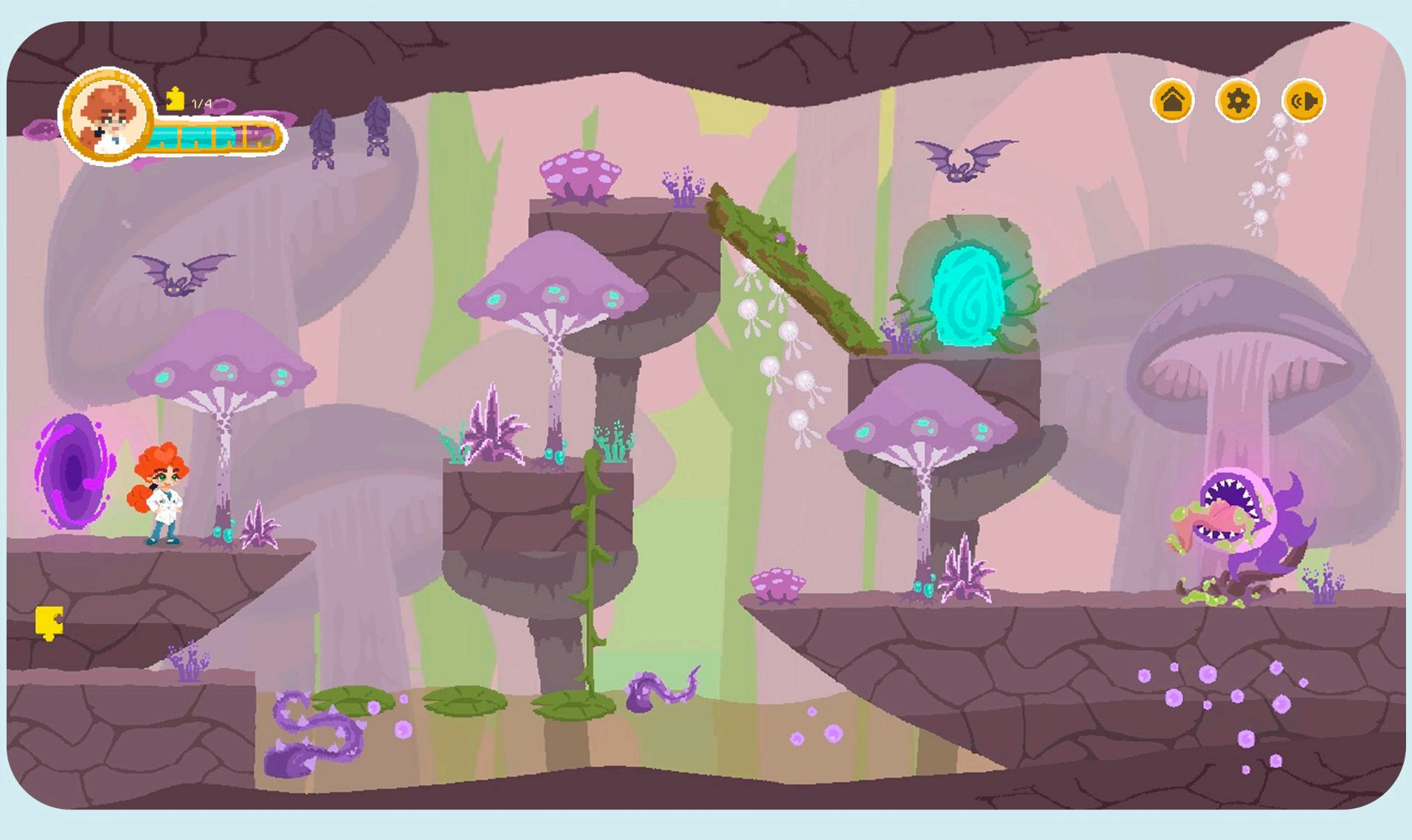
Bats
Flying around everywhere represents scattered attention.

Tentacles
It will intermittently attack nearby living creatures.

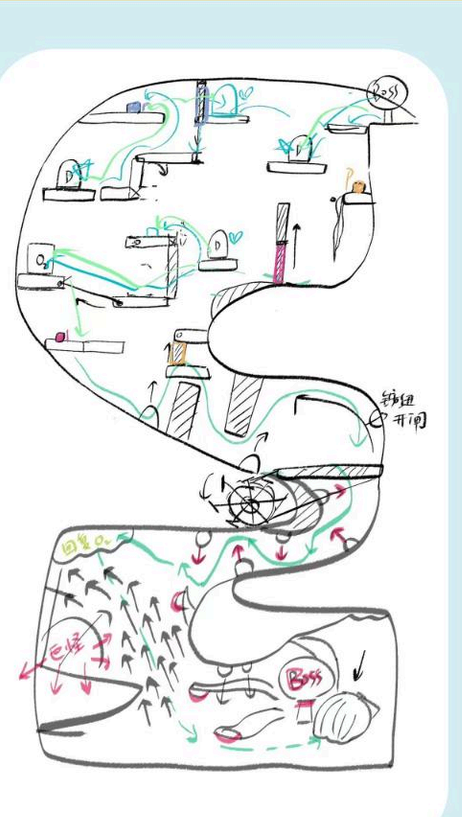
Key Frames



This scene represents Theo's mental world, a child with ADHD. It uses flying elements such as bats and low-flying jellyfish, as well as dangerous elements such as tentacles and carnivorous plants to reflect the characteristics of ADHD.With Dr. Lizzy's help, Theo will learn to gather the scattered "puzzles of focus" and find his own unique order within this enchanting jungle.



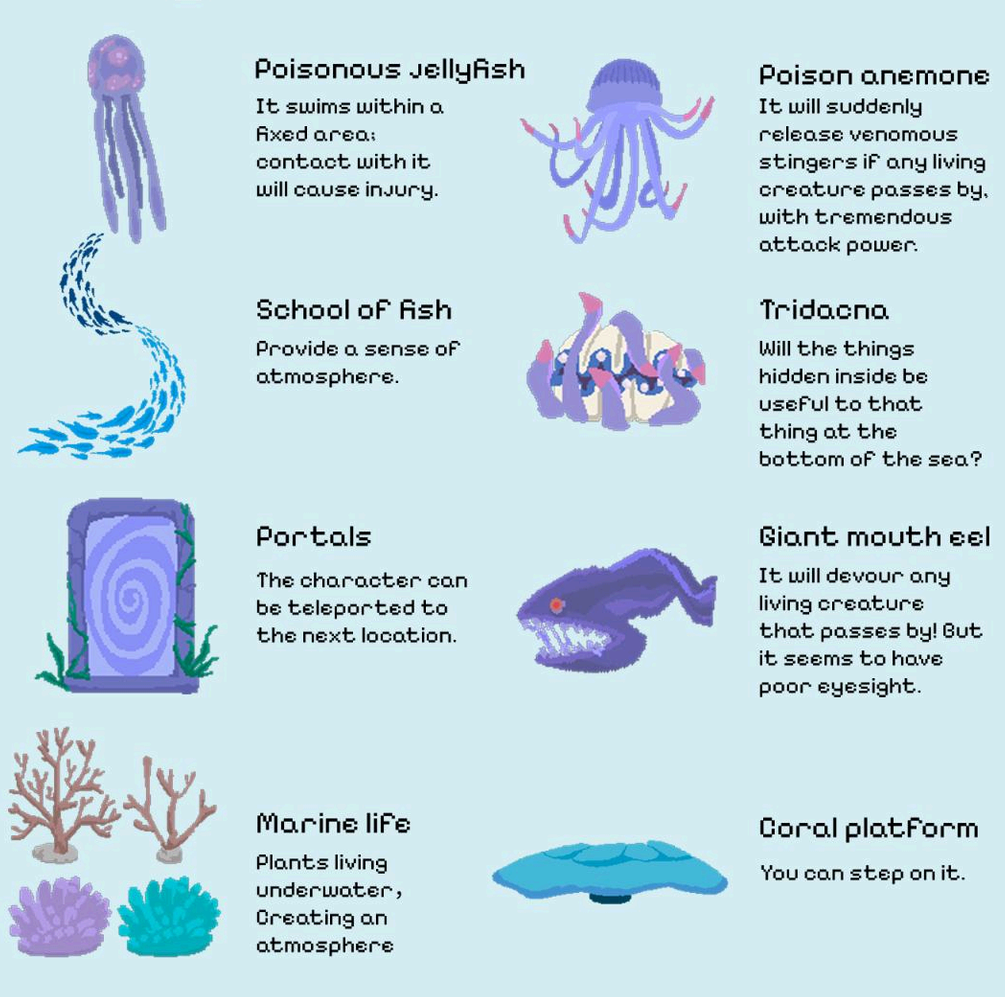
LEVEL-2



For Scene Two, I designed the map as a wavy, winding shape, incorporating numerous portals to enhance the suspense and mystery. Lizzy, guided by her "superego," must journey to the ocean depths to rescue her trapped "id."

The journey from shallow waters to deep waters also symbolizes Lizzy's growing understanding and empathy for Joseph. Facing the suffocating depths of the ocean, Lizzy must evade attacks from marine life (symbolizing the sudden onslaught of negative emotions) in order to find the crucial "key."

Key Frames



Poisonous jellyfish
It swims within a fixed area; contact with it will cause injury.

Poison anemone
It will suddenly release venomous stingers if any living creature passes by, with tremendous attack power.

School of fish
Provide a sense of atmosphere.

Tridacna
Will the things hidden inside be useful to that thing at the bottom of the sea?

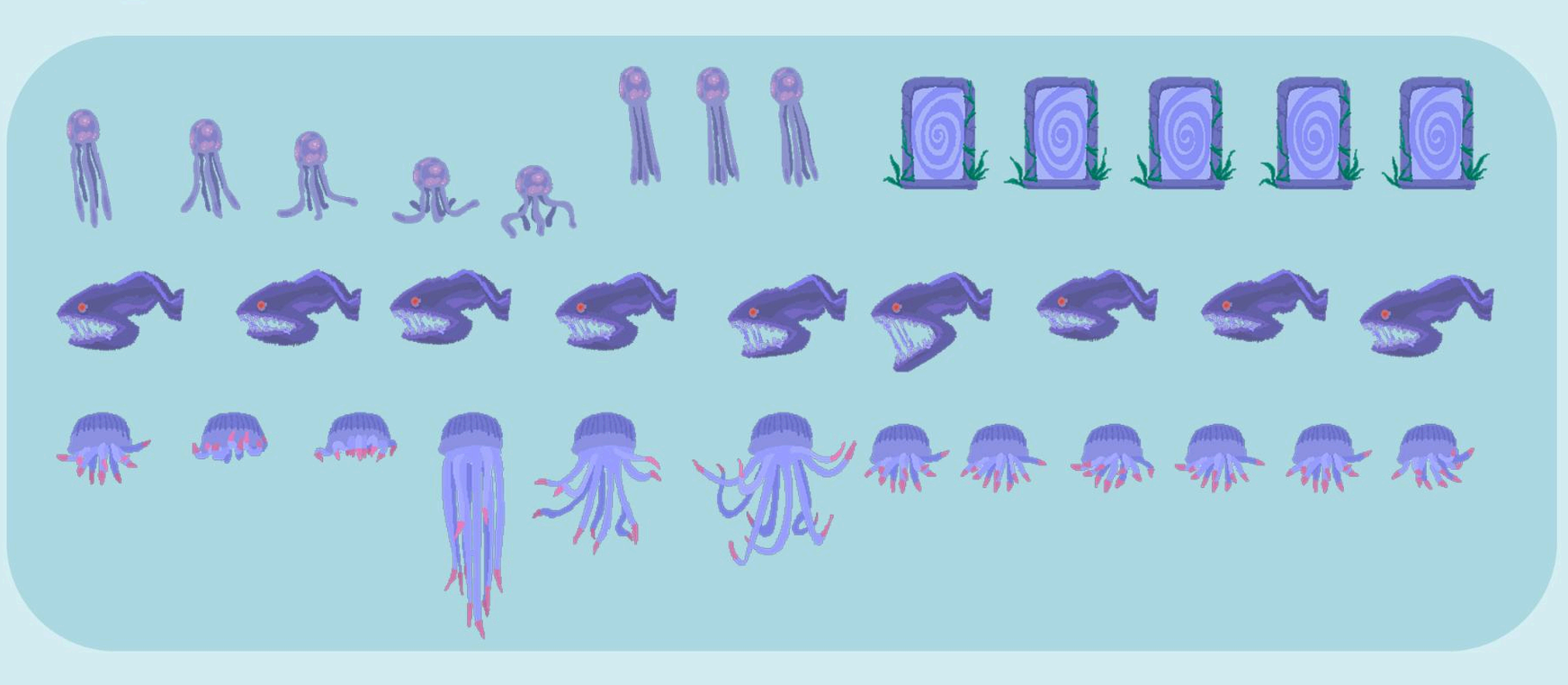
Portals
The character can be teleported to the next location.

Giant mouth eel
It will devour any living creature that passes by! But it seems to have poor eyesight.

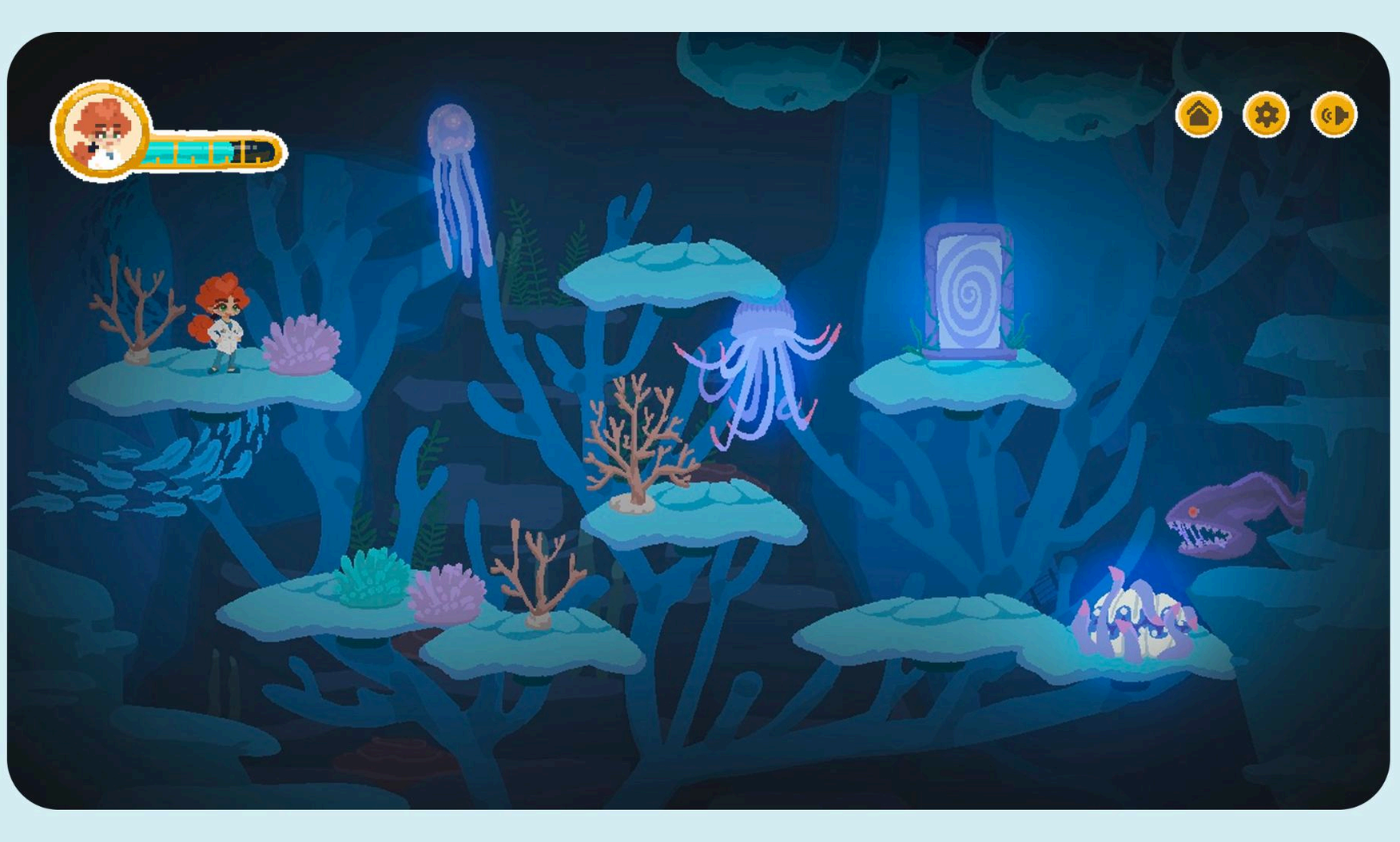
Marine life
Plants living underwater, Creating an atmosphere

Coral platform
You can step on it.

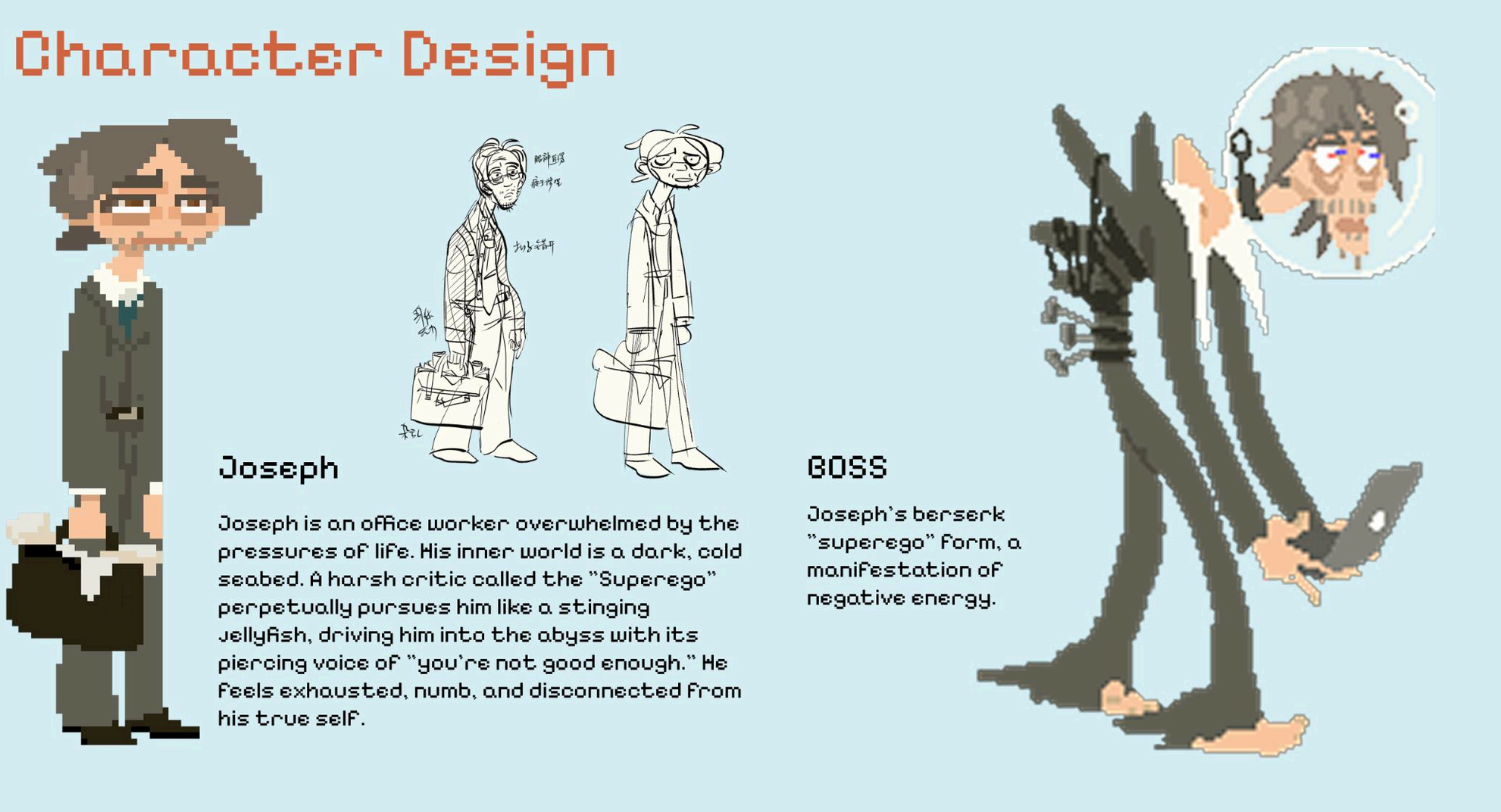
Key Frames



William's journey is to navigate this oppressive abyss, evade the relentless pursuit, and ultimately rediscover the forgotten, warm "Id," so he can resurface and breathe the air of hope once more.



Character Design



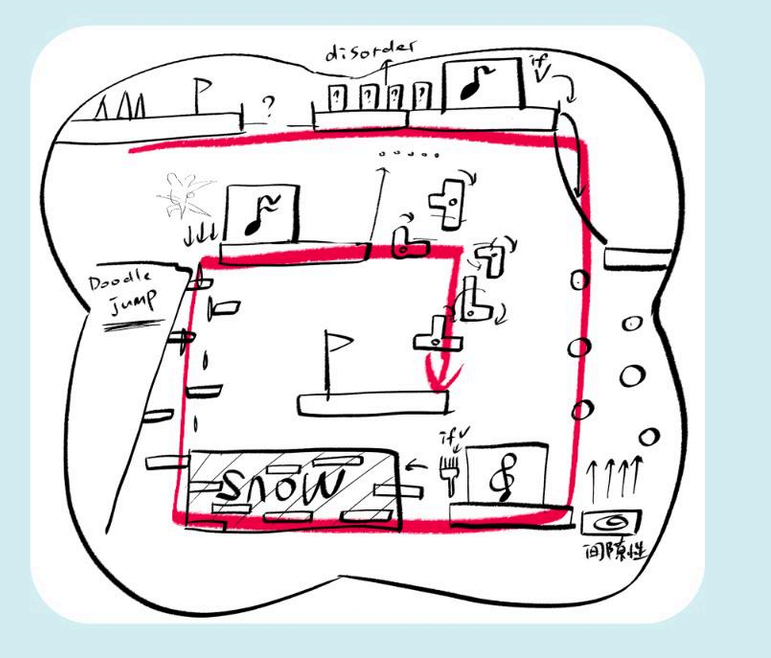
Joseph

Joseph is an office worker overwhelmed by the pressures of life. His inner world is a dark, cold seabed. A harsh critic called the "Superego" perpetually pursues him like a stinging jellyfish, driving him into the abyss with its piercing voice of "you're not good enough." He feels exhausted, numb, and disconnected from his true self.

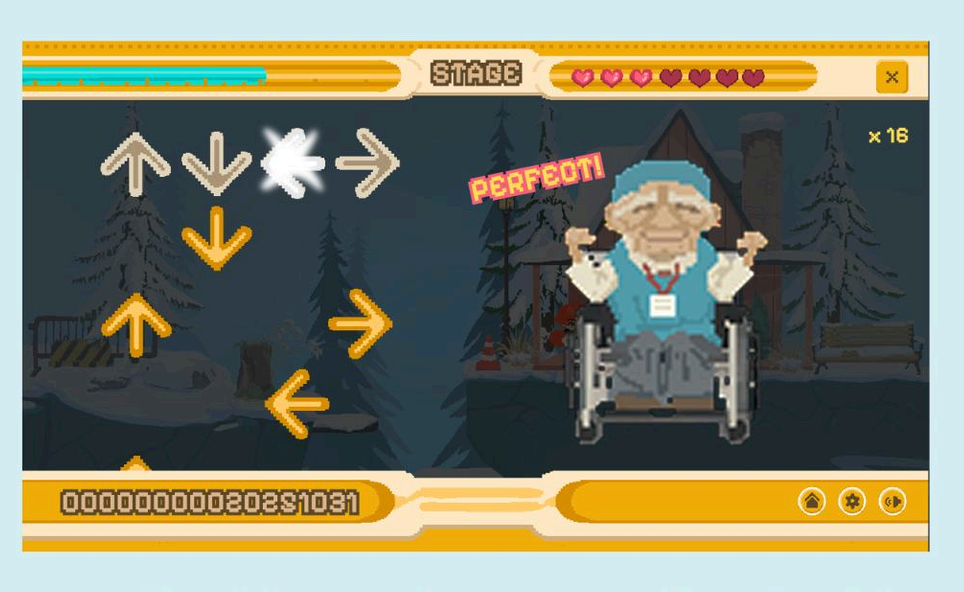
BOSS

Joseph's berserk "superego" form, a manifestation of negative energy.

LEVEL-3

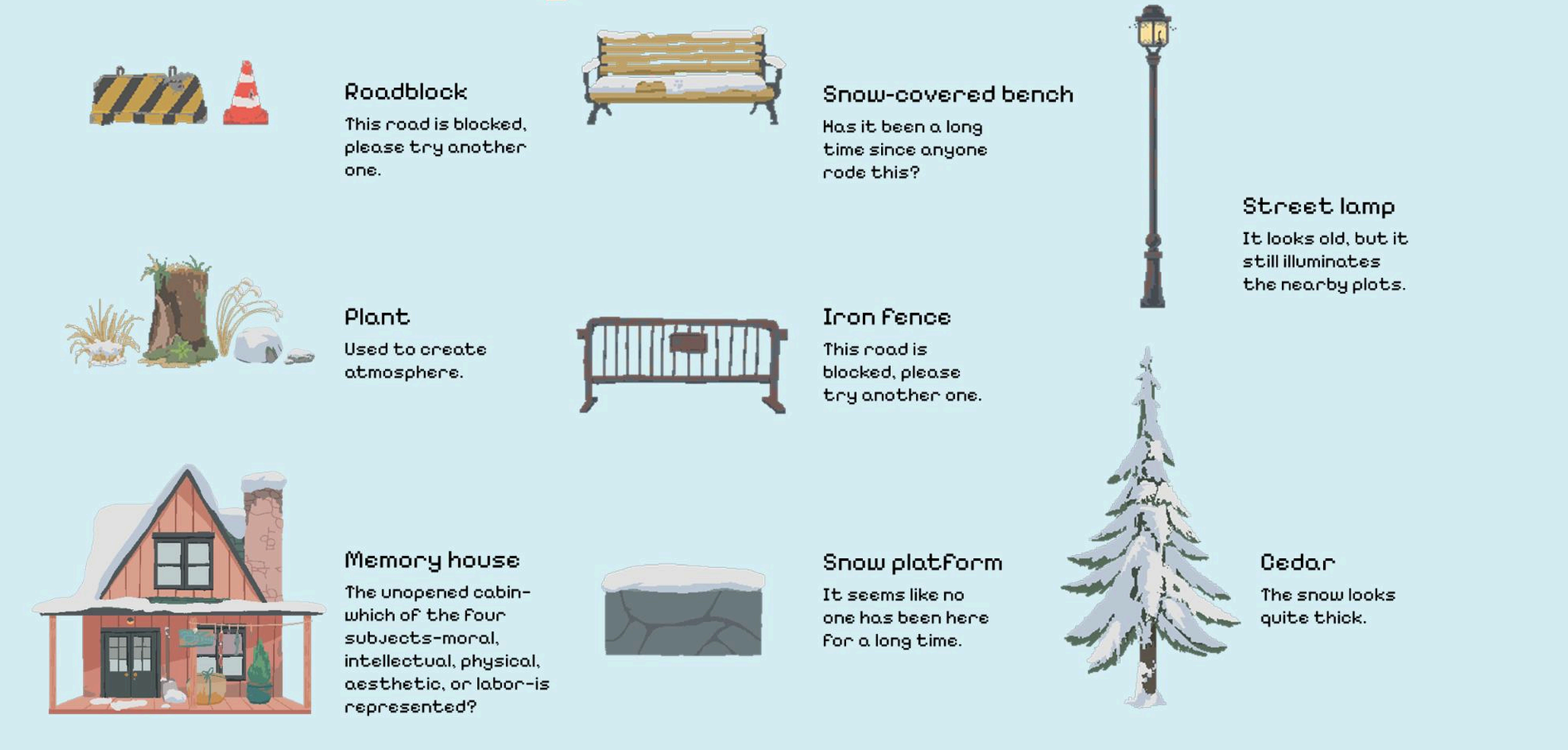


-Dazzles to Dance-



Based on professional books and relevant data, Art therapy (thematic expression through painting/collage, listening to personalized music and singing, dance art), Grandpa's Dazzles to Dance helps him reach the end.
Guided by Lizzy, embarks on a warm journey of recovery, aiming to "unlock" these sealed houses one by one, re-ignite the lights within, and weave those precious moments back into the story of his life.

Elements Design



Roadblock
This road is blocked, please try another one.

Snow-covered bench
Has it been a long time since anyone rode this?

Street lamp
It looks old, but it still illuminates the nearby plots.

Plant
Used to create atmosphere.

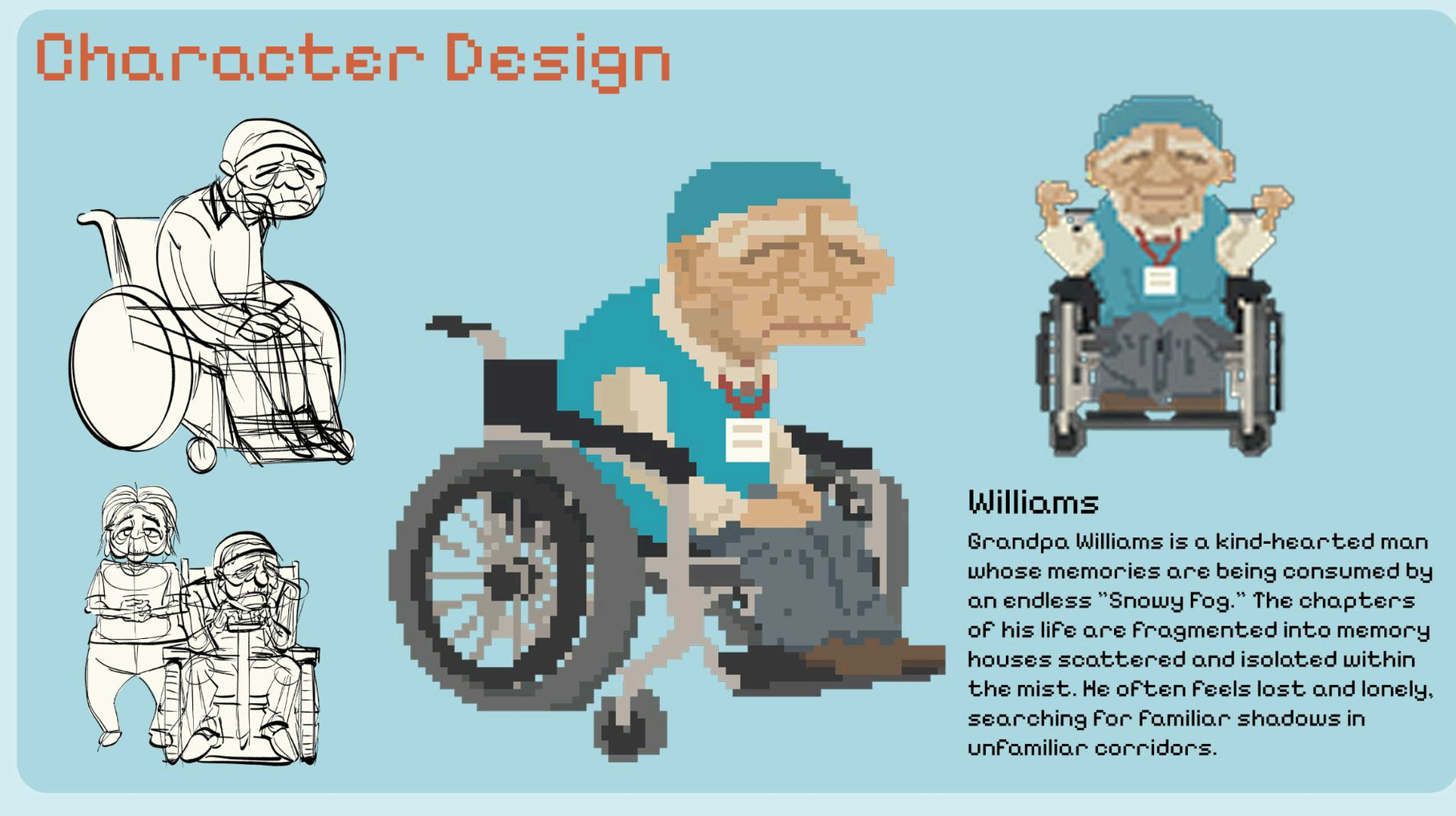
Iron fence
This road is blocked, please try another one.

Memory house
The unopened cabin-which of the four subjects-moral, intellectual, physical, aesthetic, or labor-is represented?

Snow platform
It seems like no one has been here for a long time.

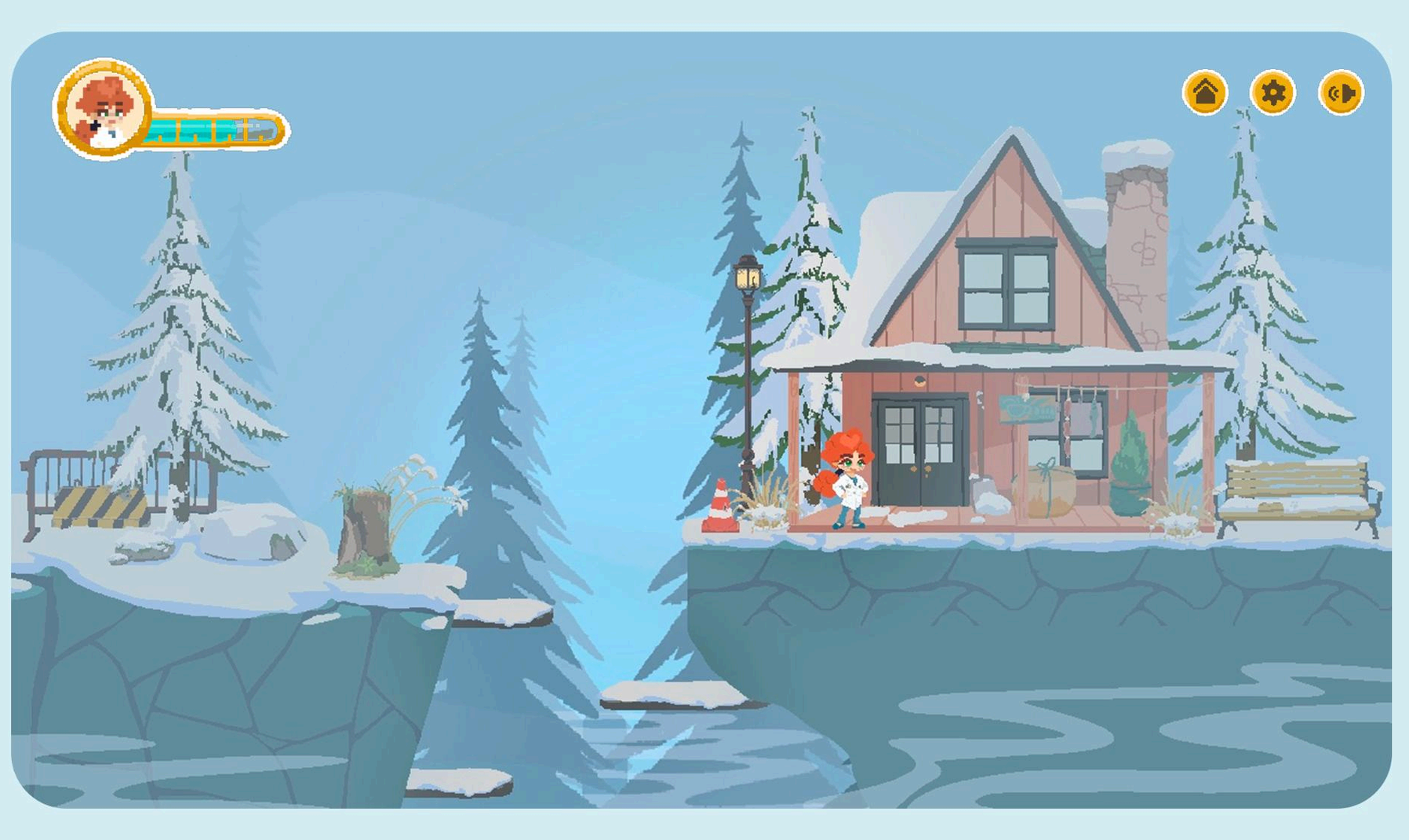
Cedar
The snow looks quite thick.

Character Design

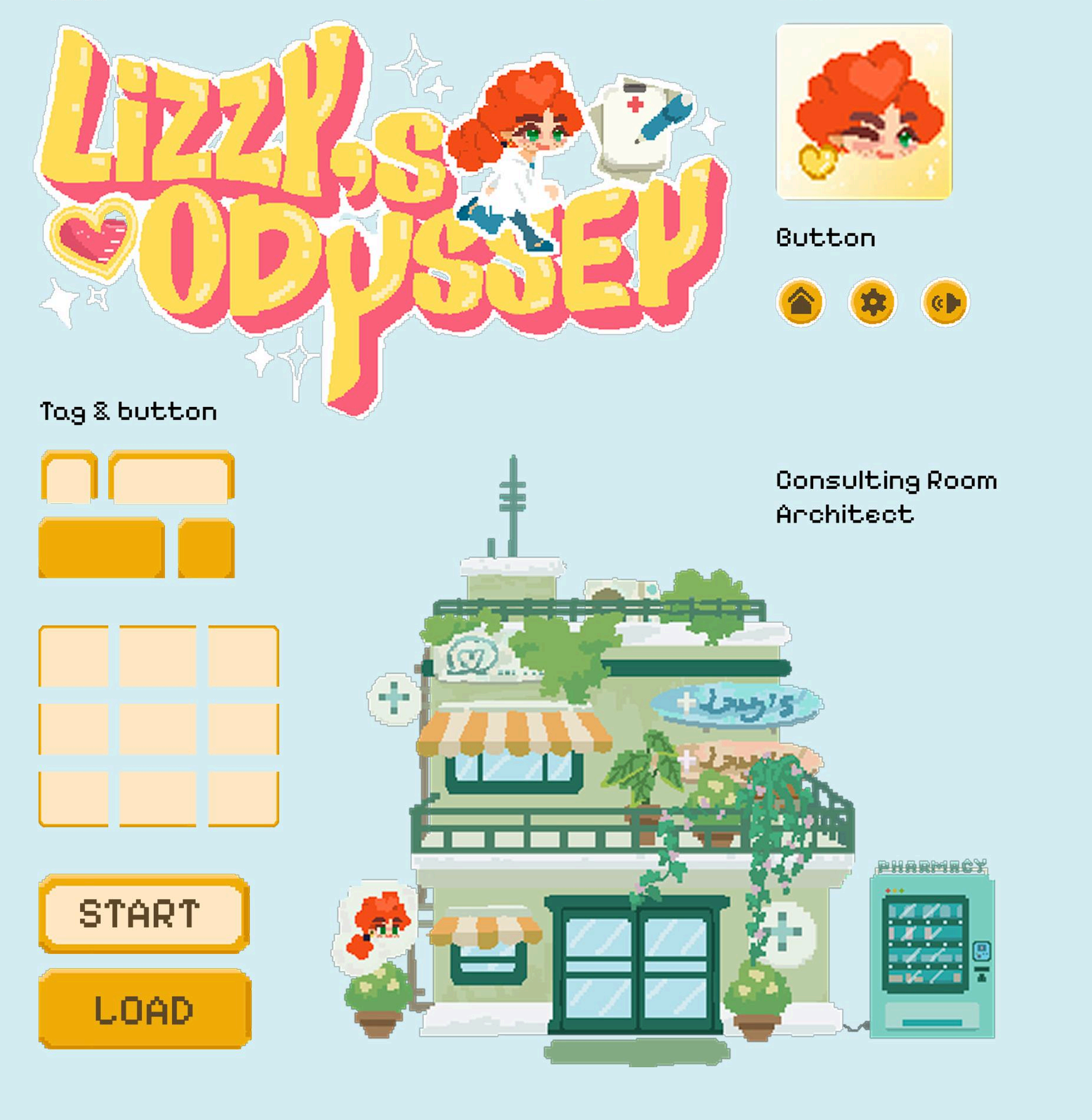


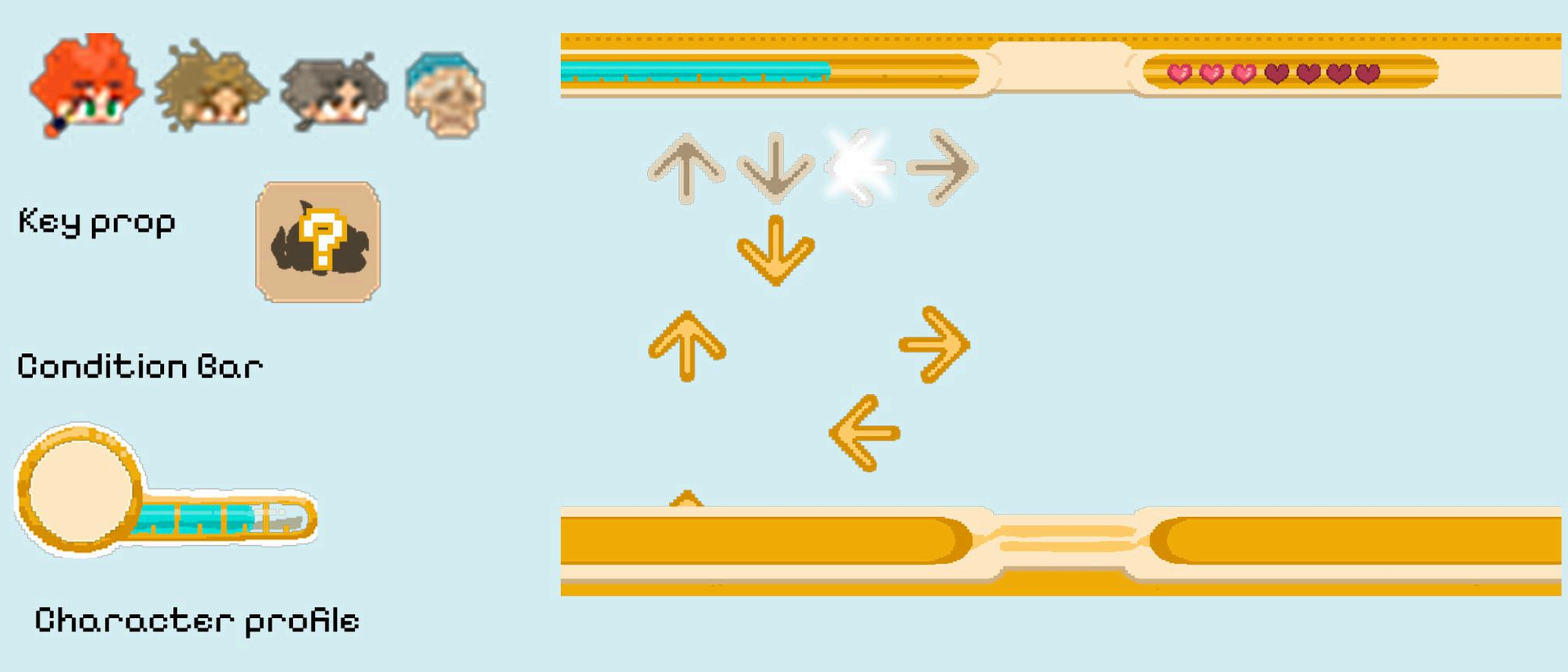
Williams

Grandpa Williams is a kind-hearted man whose memories are being consumed by an endless "Snowy Fog." The chapters of his life are fragmented into memory houses scattered and isolated within the mist. He often feels lost and lonely, searching for familiar shadows in unfamiliar corridors.

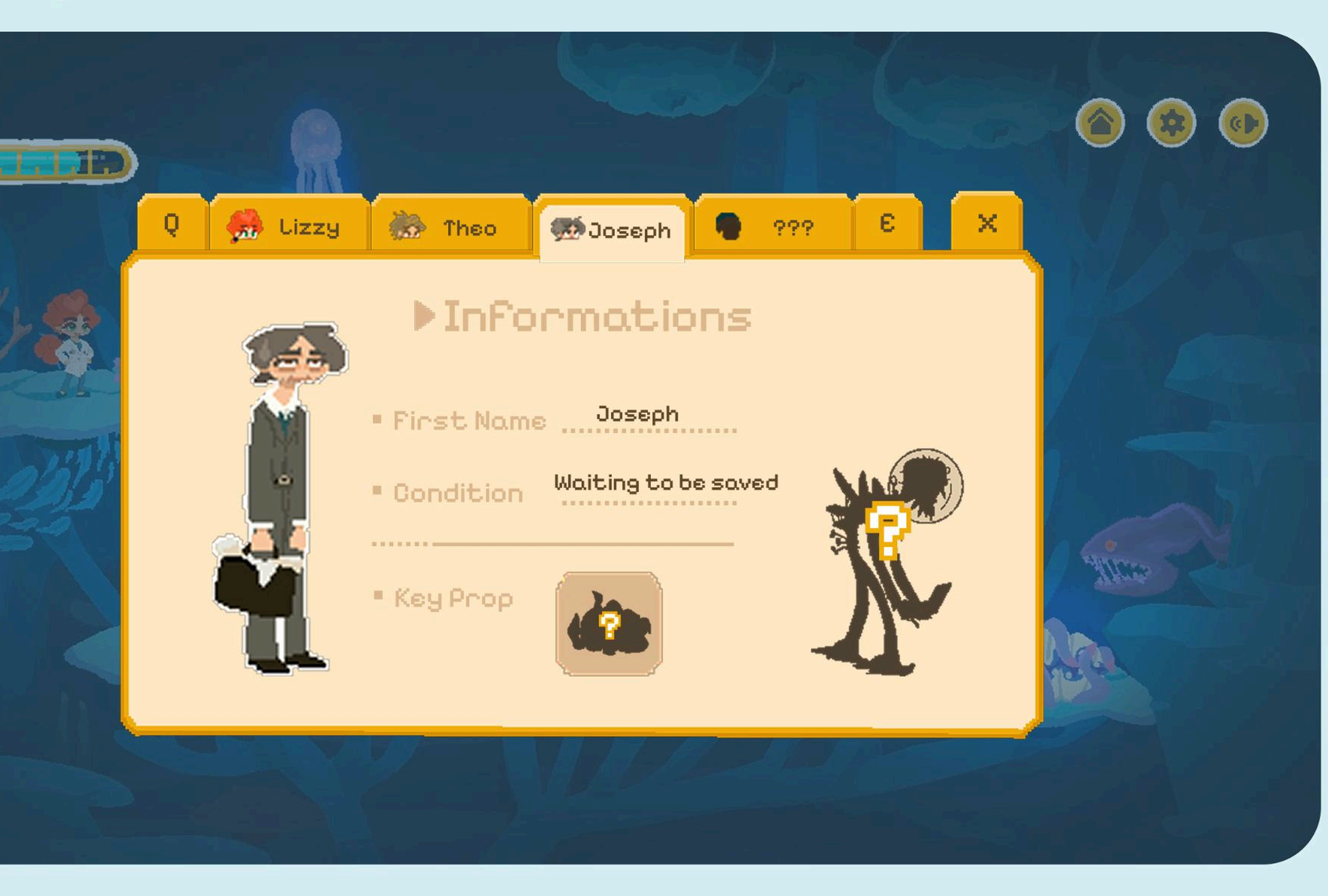


UI Design





Character profile



First Name Joseph
Condition Waiting to be saved
Key Prop

Reference

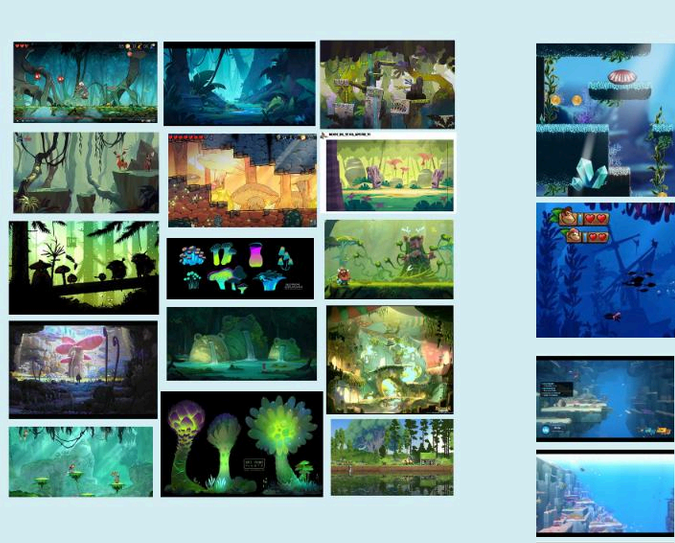
Doctor	Lizzy, Psychologist/ Consultant	Clinic

Warm and bright colors (orange and creamy white), rounded corners, not facing each other, soft tables and chairs, cute dolls, sand toys and flowers.

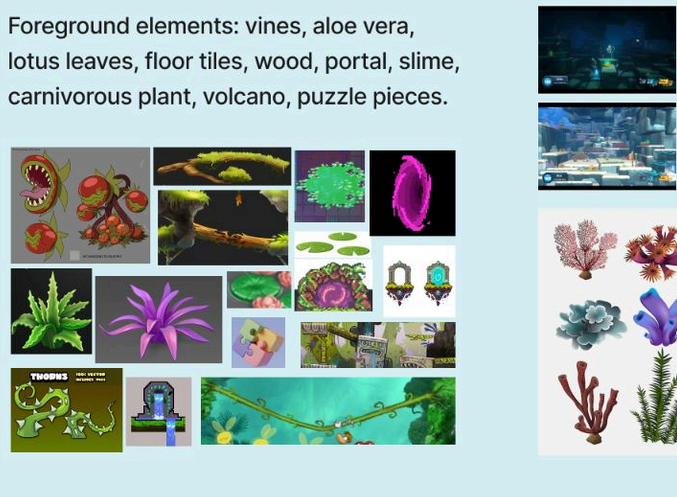
ADHD children

Jungle

How to pass: Find all the puzzle pieces and complete the puzzle within the time limit.



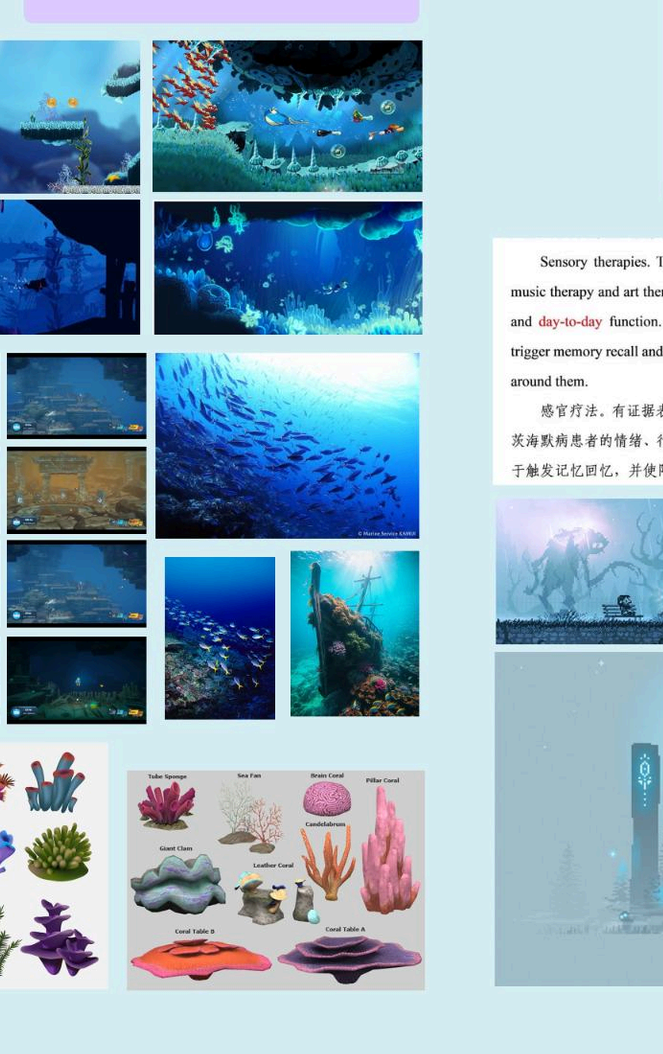
Foreground elements: vines, aloe vera, lotus leaves, floor tiles, wood, portal, slime, carnivorous plant, volcano, puzzle pieces.



Depression social animal

Seabed

How to pass the level: (You have to save yourself, the doctor only plays a supporting role) After entering the map, follow the ideal person to fight monsters and save people. When you reach the end, the ideal person becomes the boss. After purifying the ideal person, lead the doctor to rescue the real person who was hidden by the ideal person.



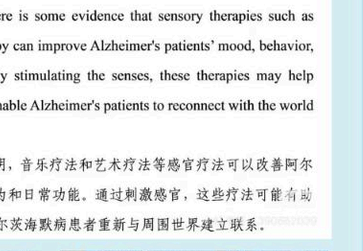
Alzheimer's disease

Snowy foggy land

Walkthrough: Art therapy (thematic expression through painting/collage, listening to personalized music and singing, dance art), Grandpa's dance performance helps him reach the end:

1. Reach a save point and start the dance to light it up;

2. Simply dance, pressing the correct direction key will make Grandpa move forward;



Sensory therapies. There is some evidence that sensory therapies such as music therapy and art therapy can improve Alzheimer's patients' mood, behavior, and day-to-day function. By stimulating the senses, these therapies may help trigger memory recall and enable Alzheimer's patients to reconnect with the world around them.

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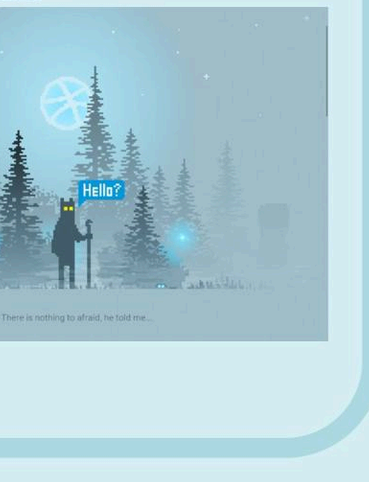
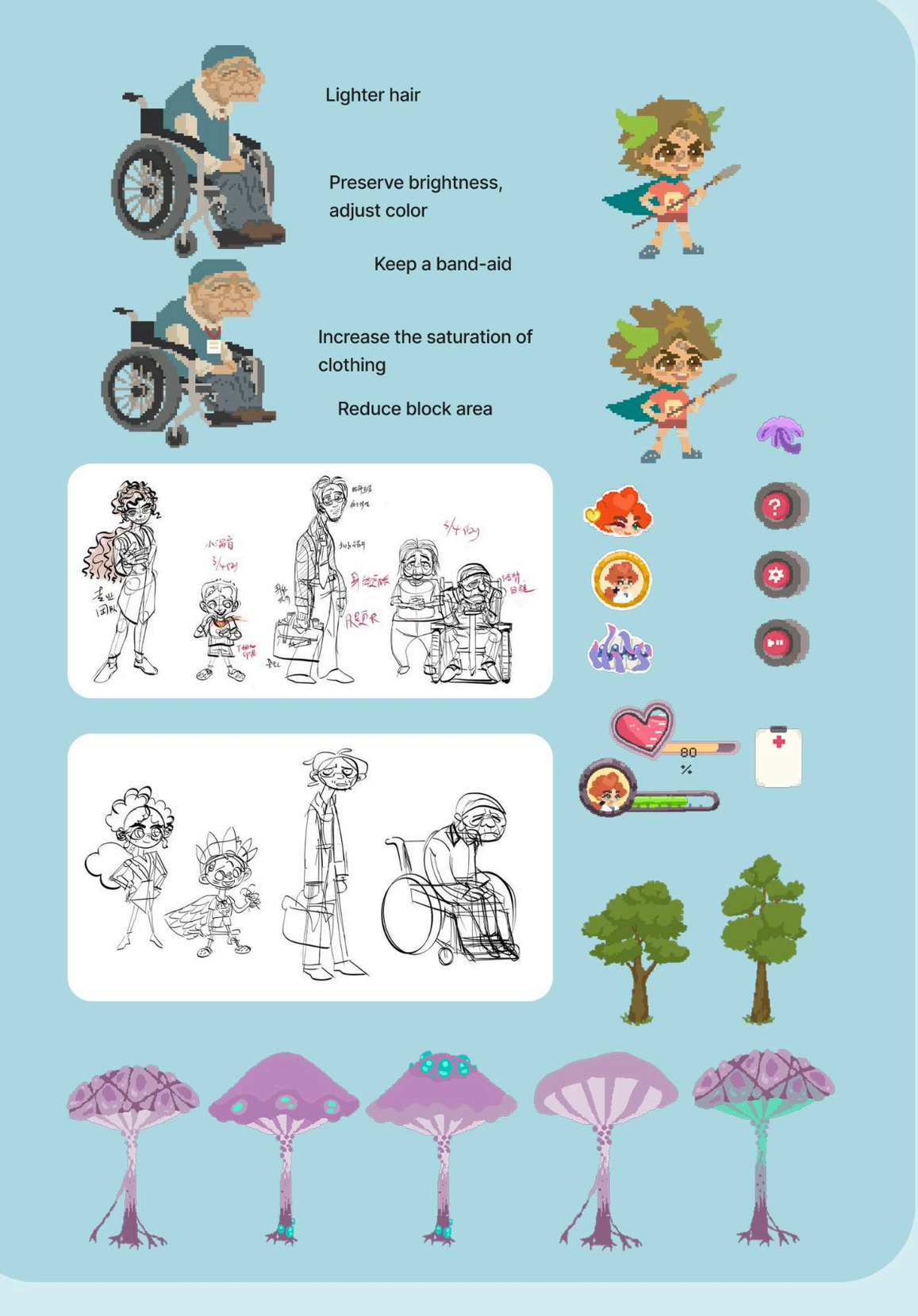


Drafts


Lighter hair
Preserve brightness, adjust color
Keep a band-aid
Increase the saturation of clothing
Reduce block area